

361 See sunspots

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To us, the Sun looks like a large, yellow disk in the sky. Occasionally, dark sunspots appear on its face. You should never look at the Sun directly, so try this safe way to view them.



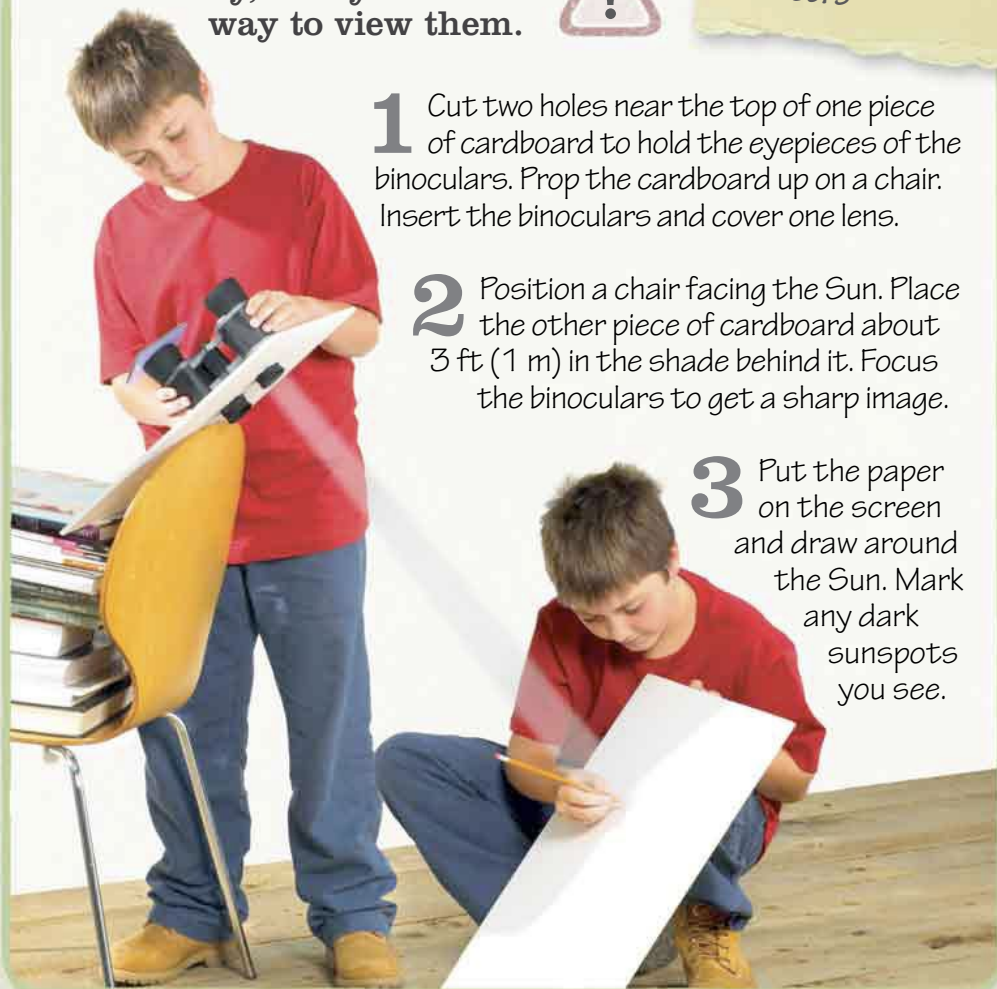
What you need

- Two large pieces of heavy cardboard
- Binoculars • Paper
- Tape • Pencil
- Scissors

1 Cut two holes near the top of one piece of cardboard to hold the eyepieces of the binoculars. Prop the cardboard up on a chair. Insert the binoculars and cover one lens.

2 Position a chair facing the Sun. Place the other piece of cardboard about 3 ft (1 m) in the shade behind it. Focus the binoculars to get a sharp image.

3 Put the paper on the screen and draw around the Sun. Mark any dark sunspots you see.



362 View an eclipse

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You can use the same sunspot technique to view an eclipse, which happens when the Moon passes in front of the Sun. Eclipses are rare, but they are always a popular news item, so look out for one near you.

Moon passing across the Sun

